

<u>Acct. #</u>	<u>Department</u>	<u>Approved FY</u> <u>2025 Budget</u>	<u>Proposed FY</u> <u>2026 Budget</u>	<u>Dollar Change</u>	<u>%</u> <u>Change</u> <u>from</u>
<u>MATURING DEBT</u>					
5910	Maturing Debt-Principal (710)	260,000	255,000	(5,000)	-1.9%
5915	Maturing Debt-Interest (750)	95,725	85,425	(10,300)	-10.8%
5910	Land Acquisition	100,000	250,000	150,000	150.0%
5915	Land Acquisition Interest	50,501	19,845	(30,656)	-60.7%
TOTAL MATURING DEBT		\$506,226	\$610,270	\$104,044	20.6%
<u>EMPLOYEE BENEFITS AND INSURANCE</u>					
EMPLOYEE BENEFITS:					
5171	Pension Expense (911)	966,176	1,108,673	142,497	14.7%
	OPEB	25,000	25,000	0	0.0%
	Clear Gov	0	17,000	17,000	100.0%
	Longevity Bonus	6,250	7,500	1,250	20.0%
5171	Unemployment Compensation (913)	12,500	10,000	(2,500)	-20.0%
5171	Group Dental	43,000	44,075	1,075	2.5%
5171	Group Health	815,000	942,730	127,730	15.7%
5171	Group Life	4,582	5,304	722	15.8%
5171	Medicare	80,000	81,160	1,160	1.5%
Total Employee Benefits		\$1,952,508	\$2,241,442	\$288,934	14.8%
WORKERS COMP/GENERAL INSURANCE (942)					
5740	Workers Comp & General Insurance	192,000	201,600	9,600	5.0%
Total Workers Comp & General Insurance		\$192,000	\$201,600	\$9,600	5.0%
TOTAL EMPLOYEE BENEFITS/INSURANCE		\$2,144,508	\$2,443,042	\$298,534	13.9%
GRAND TOTAL ALL BUDGETS		\$22,464,029	\$23,665,478	\$1,201,449	5.3%

**MAY 12TH, 2025 ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION
TOWN OF BOYLSTON, MASSACHUSETTS
OFFICIAL RESULTS**

	Tabulator 1	Tabulator 2	Total Number of Votes
<u>Board of Assessors (3 year term)</u>			
Thomas J. Martiska	301	359	660
Write-Ins	0	0	0
Blanks	67	115	182
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842
<u>Board of Assessors (2 years of unexpired term)</u>			
Thomas J. LaRoche	296	347	643
Write-Ins	0	0	0
Blanks	72	127	199
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842
<u>Cemetery Commission (3 year term)</u>			
Donald Chapin Parker	305	366	671
Write-Ins	0	0	0
Blanks	63	108	171
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842
<u>Board of Health (3 year term)</u>			
Kristen Mathieu Gonzalez	287	349	636
Write-Ins	0	0	636
Blanks	81	125	206
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842
<u>Library Trustees (3 year term - vote for two)</u>			
Azucena S. Filsinger	294	353	647
Jennifer Brennan (Write-In)	6	9	15
Blanks	436	586	1022
Total Number of Votes	736	948	1684

**MAY 12TH, 2025 ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION
TOWN OF BOYLSTON, MASSACHUSETTS
OFFICIAL RESULTS**

	Tabulator 1	Tabulator 2	Total Number of Votes
<u>Municipal Light Board (3year term)</u>			
Write-Ins	0	0	0
Blanks	368	474	842
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842
<u>Moderator (3 year term)</u>			
Kimberly Ann Kohler	290	339	629
Write-Ins	0	0	0
Blanks	78	135	213
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842
<u>Parks & Recreation Commission (3 year term)</u>			
Eric John Hoffses	298	356	654
Write-Ins	0	0	0
Blanks	70	118	188
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842
<u>Planning Board (5 year term)</u>			
Jessica L. Bourque	290	336	626
Write-Ins	0	0	0
Blanks	78	138	216
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842
<u>Board of Selectmen (3 year term)</u>			
David J. Marzo	295	365	660
Write-Ins	0	0	0
Blanks	73	109	182
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842

**MAY 12TH, 2025 ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION
TOWN OF BOYLSTON, MASSACHUSETTS
OFFICIAL RESULTS**

	Tabulator 1	Tabulator 2	Total Number of Votes
Question 1: Shall the Town of Boylston be allowed to exempt from the provisions of proposition two and one-half, so-called, the amounts required to pay for the bonds issued to pay costs of designing, constructing, and equipping a new Fire Department building/garage, including the payment of all costs incidental and related thereto?			
-			
Yes	246	311	557
No	121	163	284
Blanks	1	0	1
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842
Question 2: Shall the Town of Boylston be allowed to exempt from the provisions of proposition two and one-half, so-called, the amounts required to pay for the bonds issued to pay costs of designing, constructing and equipping renovations to convert the Gough House into a Senior Center located at 221 Main Street, including the payment of all costs incidental and related thereto?			
-			
Yes	164	204	368
No	204	267	471
Blanks	0	3	3
Total Number of Votes	368	474	842

Finance Committee

The Finance Committee uses the “Fiscal Year” as the time period to generate the Annual Report. For the Fiscal Year that started on July 1, 2024, and ending in June 30, 2025, the town budget increased by 4.4% to \$22,746,726. The increase in the budget was due to a number of factors, including increases in pension and group health for town employees, and various increases across many of our departments. Increases in the school budget were primarily driven by mandated and unfunded special education costs and employee salary increases, which are the largest portion of the school budget.

During the budgeting process – Selectman and Town Administrator requested that departments use a 3.0% increase – most departments were able to fully budget with this increase. The schools make up the largest percentage of the Town’s overall budget at 62%. The Education budget for FY2025 was up 4.0% from the previous year, with some of this increase due to mandatory costs associated with special education and significant transportation increases. This increase includes most of the cost associated with Education (BES, TRHS, TRHS Capital plus Vocational Ed). We removed “capital items associated with BES” and included them as Free Cash articles at town meeting. That total was \$285,450, resulting in an overall 6.3% overall increase for Education.

During FY2025, the town captured \$575,000 in new growth tax revenue thanks to new construction, which helps to lower the tax rate. This amount has been dropping as new construction slows down.

The free cash amount for FY2025, which was available for spending on capital projects in FY2025, was \$1,316,223. During the annual town meeting in May 2024, the town voted to appropriate a significant amount of the available funds to; Capital repairs at BES, additional highway and guardrail repairs, and a large payment to support the eventual replacement of the roof at BES. Free cash comes from a variety of sources, among them unspent budget line items, excess income from estimated excise taxes, and expected new growth. Boylston has been fortunate to have a relatively large free cash balance relative to the overall size of the budget. This free cash is available for spending on capital projects in the upcoming fiscal year and will be appropriated during the annual town meeting. However, due to the robust cost of vehicles and equipment for the fire, police, and highway departments, town building construction and repairs, and other one-time purchases, the free cash funds do not cover all of the towns needs each year.

The finance committee is committed to sound fiscal principles. Specifically, regarding free cash, the finance committee strongly advises against using free cash and stabilization funds for operating expenses. Free cash is a one-time infusion of cash and should only be used for capital expenses. It cannot cover ongoing budget operating expenses, which arise every year, and which must be paid out of reliable cashflow.